

Three books I'll have my Son read before he's 18

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/0Qp8Cgj3PDA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shares three books he read at 17 that shaped his mindset — covering emotional control, wealth-building, and the art of influence — and plans to have his son read all three before turning 18.

Contents

-  Book 1: Awaken the Giant Within — Tony Robbins
-  Book 2: Rich Dad Poor Dad — Robert Kiyosaki
-  Book 3: Influence — Robert Cialdini

Book 1: Awaken the Giant Within — Tony Robbins 0:00

- Carter read this book at **age 17**, the summer before heading to college
 - Describes it as truly changing his entire perspective on life
- Core takeaway: you are not obligated to let outside circumstances, events, or other people dictate your emotions
 - You can learn to control your own emotional state — a skill you develop, not a trait you're born with
- He calls emotional self-regulation "the most powerful skill any person can have"

Book 2: Rich Dad Poor Dad — Robert Kiyosaki 0:21

- Also read at **age 17**
- Gave him a completely different lens for understanding money — how to earn it and how to keep it
- Core takeaway: "**Poor people buy liabilities; rich people buy assets**"
 - A simple but fundamental distinction that reframes every financial decision

Book 3: Influence — Robert Cialdini 0:21

- Carter re-reads this book **once a month** and calls it an essential personal reference
- His reasoning: everyone, without exception, is a salesperson or marketer
 - Running an Instagram or TikTok page = marketing yourself
 - Owning a business = marketing your product or service
 - Applying for a job = marketing yourself to an employer

- "Marketing is fundamentally influence" — so mastering influence is non-negotiable
- Calls it the **best book ever written** on the subject of persuasion and influence